

NICHOLAS BEDIAKO POKU

Data Analytics & Business Intelligence

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Institutional Reporting and Analytics Specialist with experience leading business intelligence and data-driven reporting functions within the Quality Assurance and Planning Office (QAPO) under the Vice-Chancellor's Office at KNUST. Skilled in designing and managing systems for programme accreditation monitoring, strategic plan monitoring and evaluation, and executive reporting, translating complex institutional data into actionable insights for decision-making. Proven experience developing reporting, workflow automation, and monitoring solutions used across QAPO, the Office of Grants and Research (OGR), and the International Programmes Office (IPO), strengthening data integration within core university operations. Currently pursuing an MSc in Business and Data Analytics to advance expertise in institutional analytics and reporting.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- Institutional Reporting & Data Modelling
- GTEC Accreditation Monitoring & Lifecycle Management
- Strategic Planning, M&E Systems & KPI Tracking
- Data Governance, Validation & Compliance Reporting
- Stakeholder, Board & Senior Management Reporting
- Cross-Functional Workflow Automation & Process Improvement

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior ICT Assistant

November 2021 – Present

Quality Assurance and Planning Office (QAPO), KNUST, Kumasi

- Lead in-house Business Intelligence Analyst, delivering end-to-end analytics solutions including data extraction, modelling, dashboard development, workflow automation, and automated reporting for institutional planning and accreditation.
- Designed and built the QAPO Accreditation Tracking System, replacing scattered spreadsheets with a centralized platform to manage and report GTEC accreditation activities across 500+ academic programmes and all 6 colleges including IDL.
- Integrated accreditation lifecycle, compliance, and payment tracking; automated notifications for pending submissions, panel responses, and re-accreditation deadlines using Power Automate.
- Designed and deployed an institutional analytics suite of Power BI dashboards covering admissions, enrolment, and graduation reporting, sourced directly from SQL Server and supporting analysis of 90,000+ applicant records, five years of enrolment trends, and multi-year graduation outcomes across all 6 colleges including IDL.
- Replaced manual Excel-based reporting workflows used for senior planning meetings and GTEC cyclical reviews with an interactive, executive analytics dashboard; significantly reduced report preparation times while providing university leadership with on-demand access to key institutional metrics, including admission yield rates, STEM enrolment trends, and class-distribution analytics.
- Built integrated reporting and monitoring systems for the International Programmes Office (IPO) and Office of Grants and Research (OGR), streamlining strategic-plan and grants reporting workflows.

- Engineered and deployed a data validation and reconciliation pipeline for KNUST's implementation of the national No-Fees-Stress policy; matched student-submitted Ghana Card numbers against institutional student datasets to programmatically verify eligibility criteria including freshman status, Ghanaian citizenship, and active registration prior to portal submission.
- Act as the office's frontline contact for students facing No-Fees-Stress portal application issues, handling intake and triage of in-person complaints each cycle. Resolve 1,000+ of the underlying identity and data mismatches, clearing students to apply and safeguarding institutional reimbursement.
- Built a Streamlit web application over the validation pipeline, enabling non-technical staff to upload raw source files, monitor validation stages through a visual processing workflow, and generate portal-ready compliance exports independently.
- Coordinate and supervise KNUST's institutional ID-card production processes, overseeing the printing and issuance of 30,000+ student ID cards alongside staff, clients, replacement, and renewal cards across academic cycles, while administering access-control privileges for secured university facilities and supporting operational continuity through equipment troubleshooting, preventive maintenance, and vendor coordination.
- Support and maintain examination-scanning infrastructure across 6 colleges, troubleshooting hardware and software issues across DRS, Sekonic, and Scantron scanning systems in collaboration with the Hardware Division-UTS to ensure operational continuity during university examination-processing activities.
- Deliver training and technical support for staff and stakeholders on accreditation systems, reporting platforms, data-validation processes, and the GTEC AMIS platform.

KEY INSTITUTIONAL SYSTEMS & PROJECTS

- **QAPO Accreditation Tracking & Compliance System:** A centralized governance platform engineered to manage the end-to-end GTEC accreditation lifecycle for 500+ academic programmes across all 6 colleges and the Institute of Distance Learning (IDL). Tracks programme progression through institutional and national review stages, reconciles accreditation fees and payments, and forecasts timelines for upcoming re-accreditation activities. Power Automate workflows notify Heads of Department regarding panel-report responses, document submissions, outstanding payments, and accreditation deadlines.
- **Institutional Admissions, Enrolment & Graduation Analytics Suite:** A university-wide planning and reporting solution developed to analyse applicant, enrolment, and graduation trends across all 6 colleges and the Institute of Distance Learning (IDL). Consolidates multi-year academic data from SQL Server sources to support institutional planning, GTEC cyclical reviews, admission-yield analysis, STEM enrolment monitoring, and cohort-distribution reporting for senior management decision-making.
- **IPO Strategic Plan M&E System:** A monitoring-and-evaluation platform for tracking the institutional strategic plan across thematic areas and KPIs. Combines Power Apps data capture for decentralized thematic reporting, Power Automate reminder workflows that improved reporting compliance, and Power BI dashboards for milestone and KPI review by management and board.
- **OGR Grants Management & Performance Reporting Suite:** An institutional grants-tracking and analytics platform spanning all 6 colleges and non-college. Combines Power Apps data capture, role-secured Power BI dashboards, Power Automate alerting (expiry notifications and change-audit logging), and compliance-ready paginated reports (RDL).
- **No-Fees-Stress Data Validation & Submission Workflow:** A large-scale student-data workflow engineering project supporting KNUST's implementation of the national fee-refund initiative. Integrated student-submitted Ghana Card numbers with institutional student datasets using student number matching and eligibility validation rules to generate portal-ready submission files.
- **SONSOL Project.** Designed and managed inventory and distribution tracking system for 2500+ donated laptops from 60+ donors, producing compliance, reconciliation, and management reports that strengthened asset accountability, beneficiary tracking, and institutional transparency.

EDUCATION

MSc, Business and Data Analytics

Expected 2026

Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST)

BSc, Computer Science

November 2020

Kwame Nkrumah University of Science and Technology (KNUST)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **BI & Enterprise Reporting:** Power BI (DAX, Power Query, complex data modelling, dataflows, row-level security), Power BI Report Builder / SSRS Paginated Reports (RDL).
- **Microsoft Power Platform:** Power Apps (canvas applications, custom business logic), Power Automate (governance workflows, automated notifications), SharePoint integration, and workflow automation.
- **Data Engineering & Application Development:** Python (pandas, NumPy), Streamlit web applications, SQL, ETL pipelines, data transformation, and SQL Server integration.
- **Advanced Analytics & Data Science:** Statistical analysis, R programming, predictive modelling, Random Forest, and Logistic Regression.

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS

- Cybersecurity Certificate, NIIT OpenLabs (2024)
- Information Systems Auditing, HKUST via Coursera (2022)
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate, Google via Coursera (2021)

LANGUAGES

English (professional fluency) · Asante Twi (native speaker)

REFERENCES

Available on request.